

Informative Speech Evaluation

Your task is to review your speech and to reach a full, objective assessment of its major strengths and weaknesses. Please answer the following questions in 2-4 complete sentences each. Be specific and concrete in your comments. Explain why you had difficulty with certain aspects of this speech and indicate the specific steps you will take to improve your next presentation.

1. Evaluate the effectiveness of your organization. *Name one strength and one weakness of your organization with time stamps as examples.* Questions to think about: Did you grab attention and clearly state your main points in the thesis? Were the main points of the body clear and easy to follow? Did you memorably close?

Two strengths in my speech's organizational effectiveness were captivating my audience's attention [0:21] as well as the roadmap I laid out [1:05] because it gave the audience a clear heads-up that I'd cover biology, lifestyle, and prevention points in that order. However, a major weakness was that the body of the speech didn't actually follow that plan; I jumped into the sleep study (a prevention topic) at [5:15] before I even finished talking about lifestyle factors like aging and technology at [6:30]. Next time, I will do a better job of not improvising or straying away from my speech's planned organization/outline.

2. Evaluate the effectiveness of your content. *Name one strength and one weakness of your content with time stamps as examples.* Questions to think about: Was your purpose clear? Interesting? Did you support your points with evidence and examples?

I think my content was really solid because I used peer-reviewed, credible research to back up my points, like the "Lancet" projected-statistics at [0:12] and the study on sleep deprivation by Shakri Kajori at [3:38]. One area that needs work was at [7:35] when I claimed that using AI like ChatGPT actually "causes" the physical buildup of beta-amyloid plaques. While I had research on cognitive offloading, I didn't provide a specific study linking AI use to that biological protein buildup, which made that part of the argument feel a bit like a leap. I struggled with this because I wanted to tie the technology section back to the biology section, so for my next speech, I'll be careful to only make claims I have direct evidence for.

3. Evaluate the effectiveness of your delivery. *Name one strength and one area of improvement with time stamps as examples.* Questions to think about: Did you rush? How effective were your pauses, rate, pitch, and vocal variety? Did you feel that your gestures and movement enhanced or distracted from your message? Did you maintain strong eye contact throughout the speech?

I'm happy with my use of analogies, like comparing protein buildup to a "factory assembly line" at [1:52] or brain health to "cross-training" at [7:10], because they make the complex science way easier to understand. However, I definitely used too many vocal fillers like "um" and "sorry," especially at [1:25] and [2:48] when I was trying to remember my neuro course names or transitions between main-points/subpoints. I struggled because I was trying to memorize too much technical stuff at once, so next time I'll be sure to practice more to improve both my general confidence and my ability to recall.

4. What are you most proud of in your speech? If you had an opportunity to deliver this speech again next week, what changes would you make? Be specific.

I'm most proud of how I made the topic feel urgent for students at [0:42] by connecting it to our current classes and the future economic burden on our generation. If I could do it again, I'd slow down during the biology section at [4:15] so people could actually process the diagrams of the lymphatic system and plaque buildup. I'd also spend more time at [8:55] explaining the "deep work" and AI collaboration tips since that's the kind of advice my classmates can actually use in their daily lives.